Neilly H. Tan

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https://neillytan.com

I am a sociotechnical scholar and design researcher studying the ethical, social, and political implications of personal data and technology systems. My work focuses on multi-stakeholder settings involving Internet of Things (IoT) and artificial intelligence (AI) sensors to address privacy and surveillance vulnerabilities. In human-computer interaction (HCI), I employ qualitative, participatory, and design-based approaches to explore, evaluate, and enact techniques that support advocacy and agency in everyday computing technologies.

Education

2027	**Ph.D. at University of Washington, Human-Centered Design & Engineering (expected)** Committee: Sean A. Munson (co-chair), Audrey Desjardins (co-chair), Richmond Y. Wong, Lindah Kotut.
2022	**M.S. at University of Washington, Human-Centered Design & Engineering**
2018	**B.Sc. at Brown University, Cognitive Science (focus in Human-Computer Interaction)** Extended coursework in Visual Art. Advised by Jeff Huang.
2018	**Coursework at Rhode Island School of Design, Graphic & Industrial Design** Cross-registered at Brown University.

Awards & Honors

2026-27	**Martha H. Duggan Fellowship in Caring Labor, UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies** — $10,000
2021-26	**National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (GRF)** — $37,000 annual stipend, tuition, and health insurance for 3 years ($159,000 total)
2023	**HCDE Doctoral Grant Award** — "Contextualizing Information Seeking, Authenticity, and Safety Practices on Intimate Platforms," co-authored with Liang
2022	**UW Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award**
2021	**UW HCDE Graduate Student Association Team Award**
2020	**UW Resilience Lab Seed Grant** — $2,500, co-authored with Cunningham, Pistorus, Beers, & Lustig
2018	**LINK Award, Brown University** — $2,500
2016, 2017	**Karen T. Romer Undergraduate Research & Teaching Award (UTRA), Brown University** — $2,500, two-time recipient

Conference & Journal Publications (Refereed)[1]

* *indicates equal contribution.*

P7. **Neilly H. Tan,** Audrey Desjardins, & Sean A. Munson. 2027. ***Everyday Layers of Resistance to Smart Camera Surveillance.*** — IN PREPARATION.

P6. Shengzhi Wang, **Neilly H. Tan**, & Sean A. Munson. 2026. ***Negotiating Autonomy, Control, and Privacy in Always-On Home IoT Technology-Mediated Care Relationships with Older Adults.*** Proc. ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. (Ubicomp '26). — PDF. ONLINE.

P5. Gabrielle Benabdallah, Ashten Alexander*, Sourojit Ghosh*, Chariell Glogovac-Smith*, Lacey Jacoby*, Caitlin Lustig*, Anh Nguyen*, Anna Parkhurst*, Kathryn Reyes*, **Neilly H. Tan***, Edward Wolcher*, Afroditi Psarra, & Daniela Rosner. 2022. ***Slanted Speculations: Material Encounters with Algorithmic Bias.*** Proc. ACM Conf. on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '22). — PDF. ONLINE.

1 Top-tier publication venues in HCI research include the ACM conferences CHI, CSCW, DIS, and Ubicomp. In computer science and HCI research, students are typically named first, and faculty/senior authors are named last.

P4. **Neilly H. Tan**, Richmond Y. Wong, Audrey Desjardins, Sean A. Munson, & James Pierce. 2022. ***Monitoring Pets, Deterring Intruders, and Casually Spying on Neighbors: Everyday Uses of Smart Home Cameras.*** Proc. ACM Conf. on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22). — PDF. ONLINE.

P3. **Neilly H. Tan**, Brian Kinnee, Dana Langseth, Sean A. Munson, & Audrey Desjardins. 2022. ***Critical-Playful Speculations with Cameras in the Home.*** Proc. ACM Conf. on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22). — PDF. ONLINE.

P2. Shaun Wallace, Alexandra Papoutsaki, **Neilly H. Tan**, Hua Guo, & Jeff Huang. 2021. ***Case Studies on the Motivation and Performance of Contributors who Verify and Maintain In-Flux Tabular Datasets.*** Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 5, CSCW2, Article 448 (Oct. '21). — PDF. ONLINE.

P1. **Neille-Ann H. Tan***, Han Sha*, Eda Celen*, Phucanh Tran, Kelly Wang, Gifford Cheung, Philip Hinch, & Jeff Huang. 2018. ***Rewind: Automatically Reconstructing Everyday Memories with First-Person Perspectives.*** Proc. ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technol. 2, 4, Article 191 (Dec. '18). — PDF. ONLINE.

Workshop Papers & Proposals

W4. **Neilly H. Tan.** 2023. ***Tracing Data and the Visual Image: Implications for Privacy and Consent with Smart Home Security Cameras.*** CHI '23 Workshop on The Future of HCI-Policy Collaboration. Position paper. — ONLINE.

W3. Richmond Y. Wong, **Neilly H. Tan,** Nathaniel Gray, Jason Valdez, & James Pierce. 2021. ***Material Experiments and Playful Disruptions: Interrogating Boundaries, Meanings, and Aesthetics of the Smart Camera.*** Society for Social Studies of Science (4S). Making and Doing Session. — ONLINE.

W2. Calvin Liang, Emily Tseng, Sachin Pendse, Crystal Lee, Kimberley Allison, **Neilly H. Tan**, Ruotong Wang, Alexandra To, & Amy Zhang. 2021. ***Subtle CSCW Traits: Tensions Around Identity Formation and Online Activism in the Asian Diaspora.*** CSCW '21 Companion. Workshop proposal. — ONLINE.

W1. **Neilly Herrera Tan**, Audrey Desjardins, and Sean A. Munson. 2021. ***Human-Data Interaction through Design with Smart Home Cameras.*** CHI' 21 Workshop: Human-Data Interaction Through Design: An explorative step from theory to practice using Design as a vehicle. Position paper. — ONLINE.

Teaching

Instructor

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

INFO 355 – Information Policy Design — Winter 2027
Upcoming · Information School

HCDE 496/596 – Careful Data Infrastructures in Home Childcare Work DRG[2] — Winter–Spring 2025
Faculty sponsors: Daniela Rosner & Sean Munson

HCDE 496/596 – Older Adults and IoT DRG — Spring 2022
Co-instructed with Shengzhi Wang · Faculty sponsor: Sean Munson

DESIGN 596 – Non-Primary IoT Users DRG — Winter 2021
Co-instructed with Richmond Wong · Faculty sponsor: James Pierce

HCDE 496/596 – Discursive Design Inquiry with Home Cameras DRG — Fall 2020
Faculty sponsors: Audrey Desjardins & Sean Munson

Brown University, Providence, RI

Design Software Instructor: Brown University Computer Education — Spring 2016–18

2 Directed research groups (DRGs) are small, project-based courses offered for 2–3 credits across HCDE and the School of Art + Art History + Design (DESIGN) at the University of Washington. I designed and taught each as a graduate student instructor.

Teaching Assistant

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

HCDE 302 – Foundations of HCDE, Prof. Arpita B. — Fall 2026
HCDE 536 – Interaction Design & Prototyping, Prof. Paula Te — Spring 2026
INFO 300 – Research Methods, Prof. Spencer Williams — Summer 2025
HCDE 418 – Special Topics: Slow Interaction Design, Prof. Tyler Fox — Spring 2025
HCDE 418 – Special Topics: Interaction Design for Everyday Reflection, Prof. Jennifer Turns — Spring 2021

Brown University, Providence, RI

CLPS 0900 – Statistical Methods, Prof. Kathryn Spoehr — Fall 2018
CSCI 0130/1300 – User Interfaces & User Experiences, Prof. Jeff Huang — Fall 2017
Head Teaching Assistant · Co-led hiring & management of 15-person TA team
CSCI 1300 – User Interfaces & User Experiences, Prof. Jeff Huang — Fall 2016

Invited Guest Lectures

Sketching Methods: HCDE 302 – Foundations of HCDE — Fall 2026
Introduction to Accessibility: HCDE 536 – Interaction Design & Prototyping — Spring 2026
Panel on Qualitative Research: DESIGN 481 – Design Field Studies — Fall 2025
Guest Critique: DESIGN 481 – Design Field Studies — Fall 2025
Guest Critique: DESIGN 481 – Design Field Studies — Spring 2023
Panel on Interview Methods: HCDE 519 – Qualitative Research Methods — Winter 2022
Sousveillance Theory Lineage: HCDE 542 – Theoretical Foundations — Spring 2021

Presentations & Workshops

Invited Talks

2026 ***Caring Labor Futures in the Home.*** Reclaiming the Futures of Work panel, 4S. Toronto, Canada.
2025 ***Subjectivities of/within Surveillance*** (w/ Claire Weizenegger). The Rise of Research Security panel, 4S. Seattle, WA.
2022 ***Exploring, Enacting, Questioning: Critical and Design Research Perspectives on Sensing Technologies in the Home.*** ACM CHI Manila. Virtual.

Invited Workshop Participation

2026 Workers Confront Racial Capitalism, UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies Summer School
2025 Consortium for the Science of Sociotechnical Systems (CSST) Summer Research Institute
2023 Back-to-Back to Labor Workshop, ACM CSCW Conference
2023 Human-Computer Interaction Consortium (HCIC)
2023 UW DUB (Design, Use, Build) Doctoral Colloquium
2023 The Future of HCI-Policy Collaboration, ACM CHI Conference
2021 Human-Data Interaction Through Design, ACM CHI Conference
2021 Alternative Care Translations: Using Care as a Lens for Speculative Fabulating Workshop

Posters

2026 ***Building Power in Surveilled Workspaces.*** UW Harry Bridges Center for Labor Studies Awards Celebration.

Public Scholarship

2026 Interviewed for Vox article, ***Your Ring camera isn't stopping crime. But it might be making you paranoid.*** Allie Volpe, July 2026. — ONLINE.

2026 Co-designed a zine with nannies on workplace surveillance, ***Creating Connected Caregiving.*** — IN PREPARATION.

Academic Service

Department & University Leadership

2026 Student Co-organizer, HCDE Distinguished Lecture Keynote Speaker
2021-25 Ph.D. Mentor, HCDE Peer Mentorship Program
2022-23 DUB Student Coordinator
2021-22 DUB Seminar Coordinator
2022 HCDE Ph.D. Grant Reviewer
2020 Ph.D. Representative, HCDE Graduate Student Association
2020 Student Organizer, HCDE Ph.D. Visit Days
2015-16 Peer Academic Advisor, Brown University Meiklejohn Program
2014-15 Hope High School Math Tutor, Brown University Algebra-in-Motion

Workshop Organization

2021 ACM CSCW. Co-organizer, "Subtle CSCW Traits: Identity Formation and Online Activism in the Asian Diaspora."

Program Committee Membership

2023 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability & Transparency (FACCT)

Reviewing

2026, 2025 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)
2021–25 (4×)* ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
**Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews: 2021, 2022*
2024 ASIS&T Information Needs, Seeking and Use (SIG-USE) Symposium

Student Volunteer

2025 Society for Social Studies of Science (4S), Local Support Network
2019 ACM Ubicomp-ISWC, International Symposium on Wearable Computing
2016 Workshop on the Impact of Pen and Touch Technology in Education (WIPTTE)

Mentoring

2024-25 Priya Dhawka, HCDE Ph.D. Student
Cindy Te, Interaction Design Undergraduate
2022-23 Samuel So, HCDE Ph.D. Student
2022 Nathaniel Gray, M.S. Human-Computer Interaction + Design
Jason Valdez, M.S. Human-Computer Interaction + Design
2021-22 Shengzhi Wang, HCDE Ph.D. Student
Dana Langseth, HCDE M.S. Student
2021 Yuna Shin, Interaction Design Undergraduate
Joyce Lim, Interaction Design Undergraduate

Industry Experience

Meta, Menlo Park, CA May–Aug 2022
UX Research Intern, Data Infrastructure

- Spearheaded product research and direction on board-level Privacy & Security initiatives across Data Infrastructure through two studies: (1) Concept testing with 5 data engineers and 3 machine learning developers, and (2) Content analysis of ~300 employee experiences about privacy enhancing technologies.
- Collaborated with PMs, engineers, and designers horizontally across multiple teams and organizations.
- Results impacted product strategy with senior-level product and engineering managers.

Bolster (formerly TextUp), Providence, RI Jan–Aug 2019
UX Researcher and Designer

- Designed a secure cloud-based communication platform used by social workers and healthcare providers under HIPAA and FERPA constraints.

Affect Mental Health, Cambridge, MA May–Aug 2018
UI/UX Intern

- Led the UX design team in creating a mental healthcare startup's first resource website through user interviews, wireframing, and high-fidelity prototyping, with support from MIT and the Harvard Innovation Lab.